

14과 저녁 7시에 만날까요?

Chapter 14 — Shall we meet at seven this evening?

This chapter at a glance

주제	Topic 약속 — arrangements to meet
어휘와 문법	Vocabulary & grammar 약속 표현 / 동-을까요? / 못 동 — words for making plans · suggesting something · saying you cannot
활동	Activities 친구와 약속하기, 약속 메시지 보내기 — making plans with a friend; sending a message about them
문화와 정보	Culture & information 약속 장소 — where Koreans arrange to meet

The two grammar points are the two halves of arranging to meet: -을까요? proposes it, and 못 is how you turn it down. Between them you can hold the entire conversation.

약속 is the word to get right first. It means both a promise and an appointment — plans with someone. 약속이 있어요 does not mean you have made a vow; it means you are busy, and it is the standard polite way to decline.

도입

Warm-up

이 사람들은 무슨 약속이 있어요?

What arrangements do these people have?

여러분은 오늘 약속이 있어요? 누구와 약속이 있어요?

Do you have plans today? Who with?

The page shows three scenes: a man waiting outside a station, glancing at the clock tower while the person he is meeting arrives late; two colleagues at a desk marking a date on a December calendar; and a group at a grill restaurant raising their glasses. Waiting, fixing a date, and the meal itself — the three stages of a 약속.

무슨 약속 asks what kind of arrangement, using the 무슨 from chapter 7. And 누구와 is the "with whom" from chapter 9 — 와/과 in its "with" sense rather than its "and" sense.

어휘와 문법 1

Vocabulary & grammar 1

약속 표현을 알아보세요.

Learn the expressions for making plans.

모임 — Kinds of gathering

친구 모임(반 모임)

a gathering of friends (a class get-together)

직장 모임(회식)

a work gathering (a company dinner)

약속 — Making one, keeping one, breaking one

약속하다

to make an arrangement, to promise

약속을 지키다

to keep an arrangement

약속 시간을 정하다

to fix the time

약속 장소를 정하다

to fix the place

약속 장소를 바꾸다

to change the place

약속 시간에 늦다

to be late for the arranged time

모임 is a gathering of any size — friends, a class, a workplace. It comes from 모이다, to gather, and it is the ordinary word for the kind of get-together that has a date and a place rather than just happening.

회식 deserves its own note. It is the company dinner, usually paid for by the firm, and in many Korean workplaces it is close to obligatory rather than optional. That is why it appears twice in this chapter as a reason for missing something else.

정하다 means to decide or fix, and it is the verb for settling the details: 시간을 정하다, 장소를 정하다. Its opposite here is 바꾸다, to change — the two verbs that describe every arrangement that has ever gone through a group chat.

약속을 지키다 is literally "to protect the promise", and 지키다 carries a weight that "keep" does not quite have in English — it is the same verb used for keeping a rule or guarding something. Failing to do it is treated as a real fault.

여러분은 약속 장소를 어디로 정해요?

Where do you arrange to meet?

어디로 uses the 으로 from chapter 13 in its direction sense: "to where". 어디에 would ask which place you go to; 어디로 정해요 asks which place you settle on.

동-을까요?

Verb + -을까요? — shall we?

상대방의 생각, 의견을 묻거나 제안할 때 사용해요.

Used to ask the other person's thoughts or opinion, or to propose something.

가 커피 마실까요?
Shall we have a coffee?

나 네, 좋아요.
Yes, that'd be good.

예문 — Examples

가 후엔 씨, 오늘 같이 저녁 먹을까요?
Huyen, shall we have dinner together today?

나 네, 좋아요. 같이 먹어요.
Yes, that'd be nice. Let's eat together.

가 내일 몇 시에 만날까요?
What time shall we meet tomorrow?

나 11시에 만나요.
Let's meet at eleven.

-을까요? — after a final consonant (받침)

먹다 → 먹을까요? **읽다 → 읽을까요?**
shall we eat? shall we read?

-르까요? — after a vowel, and after ㄹ

가다 → 갈까요? **만나다 → 만날까요?** **★ 만들다 → 만들까요?**
shall we go? shall we meet? shall we make it? — ㄹ takes ㄹ까요

This is the same ㄹ pattern as the last two chapters. 만들다 already ends in ㄹ, so nothing is added: 만들까요?. If you can say 만들 거예요 and 만들러 가요, you can say this.

Notice how the answers are built. You do not reply to 만날까요? with another 을까요? — you drop into the plain polite form: 만나요, 먹어요. In these replies 만나요 does not mean "I meet"; it means "let's meet". Korean uses the same form for a statement and a suggestion.

-을까요? proposes something you would both do, so it usually implies 같이. It is softer than a flat 만나요, because it asks rather than tells — which is exactly why it is the polite way to start arranging anything.

The same ending also asks a genuine question about an opinion — 비가 올까요?, do you think it will rain? At this stage you only need the proposing sense, but if it turns up with no "we" in sight, that is why.

연습 1 — 이링 씨가 친구와 약속을 정해요. 다음과 같이 이야기해 보세요.

가 언제 만날까요?
When shall we meet?

나 토요일 저녁에 만나요.
Let's meet on Saturday evening.

보기) 언제? — 토요일 저녁

when? — Saturday evening

2) 무엇을? — 저녁을 먹다

what? — have dinner → 무엇을 할까요?

1) 어디에서? — 공원

where? — the park → 어디에서 만날까요?

3) 어디에? — 영화관에 가다

where to? — go to the cinema → 어디에 갈까요?

Each row pairs a question word with the ending: 언제 만날까요, 어디에서 만날까요, 무엇을 할까요, 어디에 갈까요.
Fixing a time, a place, an activity and a destination is the whole of arranging to meet.

연습 2 — 여러분도 친구와 약속을 해 보세요.**가** 수업 끝나고 무엇을 할까요?

What shall we do after class?

나 같이 숙제를 해요.

Let's do our homework together.

어휘와 문법 2

Vocabulary & grammar 2

왜 친구들 모임에 안 갔어요?

Why didn't you go to the get-together?

못 간 이유 — Reasons for not going

일이 많다

to have a lot of work

야근을 하다

to work late, to do overtime

회식이 있다

to have a company dinner

몸이 아프다

to be unwell

가족 모임이 있다

to have a family gathering

시험이 있다

to have an exam

야근 is 야 (night) + 근 (work) — staying at the office past normal hours. It is a specific noun, not just a way of saying 일이 많다, and it is common enough in Korean working life to be its own word.

몸이 아프다 is "the body hurts", and it is the ordinary way to say you are ill. As with 다리가 아팠습니다 in chapter 9, the body is the subject and the person becomes the topic: 저는 몸이 아파요.

Look at what these six have in common: not one of them is a choice. That is the point of the page — it is setting up the facing page, where 못 marks precisely the things you could not help.

가 이링 씨는 왜 모임에 안 갔어요?

Why didn't Yiling go to the gathering?

나 회사 일이 많았어요.

She had a lot of work at the office.

The question uses 안 갔어요 and the answer gives a reason that is really a 못. By the end of the next page you will see why the book asks it this way round: it wants you to feel the gap between not going and not being able to go.

못 동

못 + verb — saying you cannot

행동을 할 능력이 없거나 가능성이 없을 때 사용해요.

Used when you lack the ability or the possibility to do something.

- 가** 라흐만 씨, 어제 등산 갔어요?
Rahman, did you go hiking yesterday?
- 나** 아니요, 일했어요. 그래서 못 갔어요.
No, I was working. So I couldn't go.

예문 — Examples

- 가** 내일 같이 영화를 보러 갈까요?
Shall we go and see a film together tomorrow?
- 나** 미안해요. 내일 가족 모임이 있어요. 그래서 못 가요.
Sorry. I have a family gathering tomorrow, so I can't go.
- 가** 이링 씨, 왜 밥을 안 먹어요?
Yiling, why aren't you eating?
- 나** 배가 아파요. 그래서 밥을 못 먹어요.
My stomach hurts, so I can't eat.

못 — goes in front of the verb

듣다 → 못 듣다

cannot hear, cannot attend

자다 → 못 자다

cannot sleep

운전하다 → 운전 못 하다

cannot drive — 하다 verbs split

Here is the distinction the whole chapter turns on. 안 from chapter 6 is a choice — 안 먹어요, I don't eat it. 못 is an inability — 못 먹어요, I can't eat it. Saying 안 갔어요 about a missed appointment implies you decided not to bother; 못 갔어요 says something stopped you. Getting this wrong can sound rude.

못 sits immediately before the verb, exactly where 안 sits. And it splits 하다 verbs in exactly the same way: 운전 못 해요, 일 못 해요, 공부 못 해요 — never 못 운전해요. If you learned the 안 rule in chapter 6, you already know this one.

The last exchange on the page is worth studying. The question asks 왜 밥을 안 먹어요? and the answer replies 못 먹어요 — the speaker is gently correcting the assumption. It is not that she is refusing food; she is unable to eat it.

못 also covers being no good at something: 저는 노래를 못 해요, I can't sing. Korean does not distinguish "cannot right now" from "cannot at all" here — context does that work.

연습 1 — 어제 모임에 왜 못 갔어요? 이야기해 보세요.

- 가** 어제 모임에 왜 못 왔어요?
Why couldn't you come to the gathering yesterday?
- 나** 미안해요. 가족 모임이 있었어요. 그래서 못 갔어요.
Sorry. I had a family gathering, so I couldn't go.

보기) 가족 모임이 있다

have a family gathering → 못 갔어요

2) 갑자기 일이 생기다

something came up suddenly → 못 갔어요

1) 몸이 아프다

be unwell → 못 갔어요

3) 회식을 하다

have a company dinner → 못 갔어요

갑자기 일이 생기다 is the all-purpose Korean excuse: 생기다 means "to arise, to come about", so it is literally "work suddenly arose". It is vague on purpose, and perfectly acceptable — nobody expects you to elaborate.

Notice the question uses 못 왔어요 and the answer uses 못 갔어요. Korean is strict about direction: 오다 from the speaker's point of view, 가다 from yours. English lets you say "come" for both.

연습 2 — 여러분은 왜 학교에 못 왔어요? 왜 모임에 못 갔어요? 이야기해 보세요.

말하기와 듣기

Speaking & listening

이링 씨와 샤오편 씨가 약속해요. 다음과 같이 이야기해 보세요.

Yiling and Xiaofen are making plans. Practise the conversation below.

샤오편 이링 씨, 오늘 같이 저녁 먹을까요?

Yiling, shall we have dinner together today?

이링 미안해요. 오늘은 약속이 있어요. 그래서 못 먹어요.

Sorry, I have plans today, so I can't.

샤오편 그럼 내일 같이 저녁 먹을까요?

Then shall we have dinner together tomorrow?

이링 네, 좋아요. 내일 저녁 7시에 만나요.

Yes, that'd be good. Let's meet at seven tomorrow evening.

Swap in these sets

1) 저녁을 먹다 | 약속이 있다, 못 먹다

have dinner | have plans, can't

2) 영화를 보다 | 회사 일이 많다, 못 보다

see a film | a lot of work at the office, can't

This four-line exchange is the shape every such conversation takes: propose with **을까요**, decline with **미안해요** plus a reason plus **못**, propose again for another day, accept and fix the time. Learn the whole thing as one unit.

오늘은 carries 은 on top of 오늘, and that topic marker is doing real work: it means "today, as opposed to other days". It softens the refusal by implying another day would be fine — which is exactly what happens next.

그럼 is the everyday short form of 그러면 from chapter 12: "then, in that case". It is the natural way to pivot after a refusal, and it signals you are about to offer an alternative.

연습 2 — 여러분은 오늘 뭐 하고 싶어요? 친구와 약속을 해 보세요.

가 오늘 같이 쇼핑할까요?

Shall we go shopping together today?

나 미안해요. 오늘은 약속이 있어요.

Sorry, I have plans today.

듣기 — 잠시드 씨와 라흐만 씨가 이야기해요. 잘 듣고 답해 보세요.

1) 잠시드 씨는 왜 약속을 못 지켜요?

Why can't Jamshid keep the arrangement?

① () 요일에 만나요.

They'll meet on () day.

2) 잠시드 씨와 라흐만 씨는 언제 만나요?

When will Jamshid and Rahman meet?

② () 시에 만나요.

They'll meet at () o'clock.

약속을 못 지켜요 is the chapter's vocabulary and grammar in one phrase — the keeping verb from page 154 and the 못 from page 157. Listen for the reason first; it will be one of the six from page 156.

읽기와 쓰기

Reading & writing

다음 글을 읽고 질문에 답해 보세요.

Read the message and answer the questions.

The text is laid out as a phone message from 라민 to a group chat, sent at 오후 4:16 and ending with a smiling emoji. It is the first authentic digital text in the book, and reading a group message is exactly the skill the chapter is building towards.

여러분 안녕하세요?

Hello everyone.

우리 반 친구 디요라 씨가 다음 달에 고향에 갈 거예요.

Our classmate Diyora is going home next month.

다음 달부터 우리와 같이 한국어 공부를 못 해요.

From next month she won't be able to study Korean with us.

그래서 다음 주 토요일 6시 30분에 우리 반 모임을 할 거예요.

So we're going to have a class get-together next Saturday at 6:30.

센터 옆 한국 식당에서 식사할까요?

Shall we eat at the Korean restaurant next to the centre?

토요일에 누가 못 와요? 답장해 주세요.

Who can't come on Saturday? Please reply.

Count the grammar in this short message: 갈 거예요 and 할 거예요 from chapter 12, 못 해요 and 못 와요 from this one, 식사할까요 the proposal, and 답장해 주세요 the -어 주다 request from chapter 11. Six chapters are working at once.

누가 못 와요? is the practical line here. It asks who is unable to come rather than who is not coming — 못 rather than 안 — because the writer is assuming everyone wants to be there. That assumption is itself a small politeness.

답장하다 is to reply to a message: 답 (answer) plus 장 (letter). 답장해 주세요 is what you write at the end of any group message that needs numbers, and it is worth memorising whole.

Questions

1) 왜 반 모임을 해요?

Why are they having a class get-together?

② 고향 친구가 한국에 와요.

A friend from home is coming to Korea —

④ 다음 주에 친구 생일이 있어요.

It's a classmate's birthday next week —

3) 모임은 어디에서 해요?

Where is it? → 센터 옆 한국 식당에서 해요

① 친구가 고향에 가요.

A classmate is going home — ○

③ 새 친구가 우리 반에 왔어요.

A new classmate has joined —

2) 모임은 언제 해요?

When is the gathering? → 다음 주 토요일 6시 30분에 해요

Option ③ is the trap, and it turns on one word. 새 means "new", and the message never says a new classmate arrived — it says one is leaving. Read the direction of travel, not just the words 친구 and 반.

센터 옆 means "next to the centre" — 옆 is "beside", placed after the noun as Korean always places its position words. The 센터 here is the KIIP centre where the class meets.

여러분은 어떤 모임을 하고 싶어요? 언제, 어디에서 하고 싶어요? 친구들에게 메시지를 써 보세요.

여러분 안녕하세요?

Hello everyone.

다음 주 토요일이 제 생일이에요. 우리 반 친구들과 생일 파티를 하고 싶어요.

Next Saturday is my birthday. I'd like to have a birthday party with my classmates.

Follow the model message: greet, give the reason, name the day and time, propose the place with 을까요, and close by asking who can't make it. That last question is what turns an announcement into an invitation.

단어장 — New words

답장하다

to reply to a message

새

new

문화와 정보 — 약속 장소

Culture & information — Where Koreans arrange to meet

한국 사람들의 약속 장소는 과거와 많이 달라졌습니다.

Where Koreans arrange to meet has changed a great deal from the past.

예전에는 카페나, 지하철역 앞, 극장 앞처럼 사람들이 많은 장소에서 만났습니다.

People used to meet in busy places — a café, in front of a subway station, outside a cinema.

쉽게 찾을 수 있기 때문입니다.

Because they were easy to find.

그러나 요즘에는 휴대 전화가 있어서 약속 장소를 미리 정하지 않는 사람도 많습니다.

But these days, because everyone has a mobile phone, plenty of people don't fix a meeting place in advance.

요즘은 휴대 전화로 할 일을 먼저 정합니다. 그리고 그 장소에서 만납니다.

Nowadays they decide what to do by phone first, and then meet at that place.

영화를 보면, "극장에서 만나요. 도착하면 전화하세요."처럼 말합니다.

If it's a film, they say something like "See you at the cinema. Call me when you arrive."

The old landmarks were chosen because they were unmissable, and some are famous for it — the statue outside 강남역 exit 10, or the steps at 홍대입구. If someone still names one of these, they are using the old system, and it works.

휴대 전화로 uses the 으로 from chapter 13 in its instrument sense: by phone. 휴대 means portable, so a mobile is literally a "carried phone". In speech most people just say 핸드폰 or 폰.

도착하면 전화하세요 is the single most useful sentence on this page. 도착하다 is to arrive, and -면 means "when, if" — you have not learned it yet, but this phrase is worth carrying whole. It is what Koreans say instead of naming an exact spot.

Two grammar points here run ahead of you and are worth recognising rather than producing: 찾을 수 있다, "can find", and 정하지 않다, a second way of making a verb negative alongside 안 and 못. Both come later in the course.

Questions

1) 예전에 한국 사람들은 어디에서 많이 만났어요?

Where did Koreans used to meet? → 카페, 지하철역 앞, 극장 앞에서 만났어요

2) 요즘 한국 사람들은 약속 장소를 어떻게 정해요?

How do Koreans decide the place these days? → 휴대 전화로 할 일을 먼저 정하고 그 장소에서 만나요

3) 여러분은 친구를 어디에서 주로 만나요?

Where do you usually meet your friends?

주로 is the "mainly" from chapter 13, still sitting in front of the verb. 저는 주로 카페에서 만나요 — the adverb slot has not moved.

발음 · 배운 어휘 확인

Pronunciation · Vocabulary checklist

발음 1 — 다음을 듣고 따라 읽으세요.

먹을까요?	[머글까요] meo-geul-kka-yo
못 만나요	[몬 만나요] mon man-na-yo
못 먹어요	[몬 머거요] mon meo-geo-yo

먹을까요 → [머글까요] is two familiar rules at once: the ㄱ links onto 을 giving [머글], and then the 까 is already tense in the spelling. Nothing new — just the linking you have done since chapter 5.

못 is where the work is. Its ㅈ is pronounced as a [ㄷ] stop on its own, but before a ㅁ or ㄴ that stop turns into [ㄴ] — so 못 만나요 comes out [몬 만나요]. The nose takes over from the mouth, and this happens every single time 못 meets one of those consonants.

못 먹어요 → [몬 머거요] shows the same thing with a following ㅁ, plus the ordinary linking inside 먹어요. Say [몬 먹어요] with a hard stop and you will be understood, but no Korean speaker does it.

발음 2 — 다음을 듣고 연습해 보세요.

가	월 먹을까요? What shall we eat?
나	비빔밥을 먹어요. Let's have bibimbap.
가	몇 시에 만날까요? What time shall we meet?
나	미안해요. 오늘은 못 만나요. Sorry, I can't meet today.
가	삼겹살을 먹을까요? Shall we have samgyeopsal?
나	전 돼지고기를 못 먹어요. I can't eat pork.

The third exchange is a real and useful one. 전 is 저는 contracted, and 돼지고기를 못 먹어요 is how you decline pork without making it a whole conversation. For many learners of this book that sentence will get more use than anything else on the page.

배운 어휘 확인 — Vocabulary checklist

모임
gathering, get-together

직장 모임
work gathering

약속하다
to make an arrangement

약속을 지키다
to keep an arrangement

약속 시간을 정하다
to fix the time

약속 장소를 정하다
to fix the place

약속 장소를 바꾸다

to change the place

야근을 하다

to work late

가족 모임이 있다

to have a family gathering

회식을 하다

to have a company dinner

약속 시간에 늦다

to be late

회식이 있다

to have a company dinner

시험이 있다

to have an exam

답장하다

to reply

일이 많다

to have a lot of work

몸이 아프다

to be unwell

갑자기 일이 생기다

for something to come up suddenly

새

new